

JSS1 English Language Diagnostic Bank (60 Questions)

Scope: Primary 5/6 Foundation & Full JSS1 Curriculum (Cambridge & Nigerian)

Focus: Terminal Diagnostic & JSS2 Readiness

Cluster 1: Grammar & Mechanics (Questions 1 - 20)

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
1	Choose the correct verb: "The group of students ____ going on a trip." A) is B) are C) were D) have	A	[P6/JSS1] Subject-Verb Agreement (Collective Nouns).
2	Identify the adverb: "She sang beautifully." A) She B) Sang C) Beautifully D) None	C	[P5] Parts of Speech identification.
3	Which sentence is in the Past Continuous tense? A) I eat rice. B) I was eating rice. C) I have eaten rice. D) I will eat rice.	B	[P6/JSS1] Tense identification.
4	Choose the correct preposition: "The cat jumped ____ the table." A) in B) on C) at D) to	B	[P5] Prepositions of place.
5	"He is the boy ____ won the race." A) which B) who C) whose D) whom	B	[JSS1] Relative Pronouns.
6	Identify the conjunction: "I wanted to play, but it was raining." A) wanted B) play C) but D) raining	C	[P5] Linking words.
7	Choose the correct plural: "The ____ are grazing." A) sheeps B) sheep C) sheepes D) sheeps'	B	[P5] Irregular plurals.
8	"Neither John nor his friends ____ present." A) is B) was C) are D) has	C	[JSS1] Concord (Proximity Rule).
9	Which word is a synonym for "Happy"? A) Sad B) Joyful C) Angry D) Tired	B	[P5] Vocabulary.
10	Identify the object: "The teacher praised the student." A) The teacher B) praised C) the student D) None	C	[P6] Sentence structure (S-V-O).
11	Choose the correct article: "I saw ____ elephant at the zoo." A) a B) an C) the D) none	B	[P5] Articles (a/an).
12	"If I ____ you, I would study harder." A) am B) was C) were D) be	C	[JSS1] Conditional Sentences (Subjunctive).
13	Which is a compound sentence? A) I ran. B) I ran and I jumped. C) Running fast. D) The fast runner.	B	[P6] Sentence types.
14	Choose the correct possessive: "The ____ toys." A) boys B) boy's C) boys' D) boys's	C	[P6] Apostrophes for plural possession.
15	"She has been sleeping for two hours." This is: A) Present Perfect B) Present Perfect Continuous C) Past Perfect D) Future	B	[JSS1] Complex Tenses.
16	Identify the interjection: "Wow! That is amazing." A) That B) is C) Wow D) amazing	C	[P5] Parts of Speech.

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
17	Choose the correct spelling: A) Recieve B) Receive C) Receve D) Recive	B	[P6] Common spelling errors.
18	"The dog wagged ____ tail." A) it's B) its C) it D) its'	B	[P6] Possessive pronouns vs contractions.
19	Which word is an antonym for "Ancient"? A) Old B) Modern C) Historic D) Past	B	[P5] Vocabulary.
20	"By the time we arrived, the movie ____." A) started B) had started C) has started D) starts	B	[JSS1] Past Perfect Tense.

Cluster 2: Vocabulary & Lexis (Questions 21 - 35)

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
21	A person who writes plays is a: A) Novelist B) Playwright C) Poet D) Biographer	B	[JSS1] Literary terminology.
22	"To let the cat out of the bag" means: A) To free an animal B) To reveal a secret C) To go shopping D) To be careless	B	[P6/JSS1] Idioms.
23	Choose the word closest in meaning to "Diligent": A) Lazy B) Hardworking C) Fast D) Slow	B	[JSS1] Synonyms.
24	A group of lions is called a: A) Herd B) Pack C) Pride D) Flock	C	[P5] Collective Nouns.
25	"Benevolent" is the opposite of: A) Kind B) Malevolent C) Generous D) Friendly	B	[JSS1] Advanced Antonyms.
26	Which word is spelled correctly? A) Accomodation B) Accommodation C) Acommodation D) Acomodation	B	[P6] Spelling.
27	A word that sounds like another but has a different meaning is a: A) Synonym B) Homonym C) Antonym D) Verb	B	[JSS1] Lexical relations.
28	"He is a night owl." This means he: A) Likes birds B) Stays up late C) Sleeps early D) Is blind	B	[P6] Metaphors/Idioms.
29	Choose the correct prefix for "legal": A) Un- B) Dis- C) Il- D) Im-	C	[JSS1] Word formation.
30	The suffix "-less" usually means: A) Full of B) Without C) Again D) One who	B	[P6] Morphology.
31	"To burn the midnight oil" means: A) To waste oil B) To work/study late C) To cook D) To sleep	B	[JSS1] Idioms.
32	Which is a concrete noun? A) Freedom B) Table C) Happiness D) Love	B	[P5] Abstract vs Concrete nouns.
33	"Optimistic" is closest in meaning to: A) Pessimistic B) Hopeful C) Sad D) Angry	B	[JSS1] Vocabulary.
34	A person who studies the stars is an: A) Astrologer B) Astronomer C) Artist D) Author	B	[P6] Professional titles.
35	Choose the word that best completes the sentence: "The weather was ____ for a picnic." A) ideal B) terrible C) rainy D) cold	A	[JSS1] Contextual vocabulary.

Cluster 3: Reading Comprehension (Questions 36 - 50)

Passage 1 (Narrative):

"The old lighthouse stood on the edge of the cliff, its white paint peeling from years of battling the salty sea breeze. For fifty years, Mr. Henderson had climbed the spiral stairs every evening to light the lamp. He knew every creak of the wood and every gust of the wind. To the villagers below, he was a silent guardian, a beacon of safety in the dark, stormy nights."

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
36	Where was the lighthouse located? A) In the village B) On a cliff C) In a forest D) On a beach	B	[P5] Detail retrieval.
37	How long had Mr. Henderson been lighting the lamp? A) 10 years B) 20 years C) 50 years D) 100 years	C	[P5] Detail retrieval.
38	What does the phrase "silent guardian" suggest about Mr. Henderson? A) He was a soldier B) He was quiet and protective C) He was loud D) He was lazy	B	[JSS1] Inference and Figurative language.
39	What was the main purpose of the lighthouse? A) To look pretty B) To provide safety for ships C) To store paint D) To house Mr. Henderson	B	[P6] Main idea.
40	The tone of the passage is best described as: A) Humorous B) Respectful C) Angry D) Fearful	B	[JSS1] Tone analysis.

Passage 2 (Informational - Cambridge Style):

"Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants and some other organisms use sunlight to synthesize foods with the help of chlorophyll. During this process, plants take in carbon dioxide (CO₂) and water (H₂O) from the air and soil. Within the plant cell, the water is oxidized, meaning it loses electrons, while the carbon dioxide is reduced, meaning it gains electrons. This transforms the water into oxygen and the carbon dioxide into glucose."

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
41	What is the primary energy source for photosynthesis? A) Water B) Soil C) Sunlight D) Oxygen	C	[JSS1] Scientific reading comprehension.
42	According to the text, what do plants take in from the soil? A) Oxygen B) Water C) Glucose D) Chlorophyll	B	[JSS1] Detail retrieval.
43	In the context of the passage, "synthesized" most nearly means: A) Destroyed B) Created/Combined C) Eaten D) Sold	B	[Cambridge JSS1] Vocabulary in context.
44	What is the final product of photosynthesis mentioned in the text? A) Carbon Dioxide B) Water C) Glucose D) Soil	C	[JSS1] Understanding processes.
45	Which gas is released as a byproduct of this process? A) Carbon Dioxide B) Nitrogen C) Oxygen D) Helium	C	[JSS1] Cause and effect.
46	The passage is primarily about: A) How plants sleep B) The process of making food in plants C) The types of soil D) The history of farming	B	[P6] Main idea/Summary.
47	What role does chlorophyll play? A) It absorbs sunlight B) It releases water C) It creates soil D) It eats glucose	A	[JSS1] Function of components.

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
48	"Oxidized" in the text refers to: A) Gaining electrons B) Losing electrons C) Turning green D) Growing tall	B	[Cambridge JSS1] Understanding technical definitions.
49	Which of these is NOT required for photosynthesis according to the text? A) Sunlight B) Carbon Dioxide C) Water D) Oxygen	D	[JSS1] Negative detail retrieval.
50	The style of this passage is best described as: A) Narrative B) Expository/Scientific C) Persuasive D) Poetic	B	[JSS1] Text type identification.

Cluster 4: Summary & Critical Thinking (Questions 51 - 60)

No.	Question & Options	Ans	Source & Diagnostic Purpose
51	Which sentence best summarizes the lighthouse passage? A) Mr. Henderson liked the sea. B) A lighthouse keeper protected ships for 50 years. C) The paint was peeling. D) The stairs were spiral.	B	[JSS1] Summary skills.
52	What is the most important detail in the photosynthesis passage? A) Plants use sunlight to make food. B) Plants are green. C) Soil is important. D) Water is wet.	A	[JSS1] Identifying key information.
53	If Mr. Henderson stopped lighting the lamp, what would likely happen? A) The village would be happier. B) Ships might crash. C) The paint would stop peeling. D) The wind would stop.	B	[P6] Prediction/Inference.
54	Why is the title "The Silent Guardian" appropriate? A) Because he was a soldier. B) Because he worked quietly to keep others safe. C) Because he didn't like talking. D) Because the lighthouse was small.	B	[JSS1] Critical analysis of titles.
55	Which word would best replace "beacon" in the first passage? A) Light B) Shadow C) Sound D) Wall	A	[JSS1] Contextual synonyms.
56	In the photosynthesis text, "reduced" means: A) Made smaller B) Gained electrons C) Lost weight D) Became cheaper	B	[Cambridge JSS1] Scientific vocabulary.
57	What is the author's purpose in the second passage? A) To entertain B) To inform C) To persuade D) To argue	B	[JSS1] Author's intent.
58	Which of these is a fact from the lighthouse passage? A) Mr. Henderson was the best keeper. B) The lighthouse was beautiful. C) Mr. Henderson climbed the stairs every evening. D) The villagers were grateful.	C	[P6] Fact vs Opinion.
59	What can you infer about the villagers' feelings toward Mr. Henderson? A) They disliked him. B) They relied on him. C) They ignored him. D) They were afraid of him.	B	[JSS1] Character inference.
60	Diagnostic Insight: Students who struggle with Cluster 3 (Scientific Reading) often need extra support in JSS2 Science subjects where text-heavy explanations are common.	-	[Final Note] Cross-curricular readiness.